habitat.

Evolution The process by which species change over time as traits are passed down over generations.

Extinction The permanent dying out of an entire species.

Extirpation Extinction of a species on a local level (when a species dies out in a specific geographic area but still exists elsewhere on the planet).

Feedback loop The effect that one part of an ecosystem has on the rest, and how this change feeds back into the system as a whole.

Fertilizers Substances, which can be either natural or chemical, that are added to soil to increase its nutrient content and help plants grow more successfully.

Fieldwork Studies undertaken in the wild, rather than under controlled laboratory conditions.

Food chain A series of predators and prey with each organism dependent on the preceding life form for food.

Food web A collection of food chains within an ecosystem and the connections between them, illustrating how communities interact on a wider scale to survive.

Fossil The remains of a prehistoric organism, preserved and solidified in sedimentary rock or amber.

Fossil fuel Nonrenewable fuels formed over millions of years from plant and animal remains.

Fracking A process by which oil or gas can be extracted from the ground. Fracking involves drilling down and injecting liquid into the rock at a high pressure in order to force the oil and gas to the surface.

Fungi A group of organisms, including mushrooms, that produce spores and feed on organic matter. Unlike plants, fungi do not utilize sunlight for growth.